

Final assignment: User study

CM2010: Socio-cultural perspectives to innovative technologies and des

Your final assignment: User study

- User study is a 'study design' that contains a description of investigating and involving users in the design process of technology
- Study design: Description and analysis of *how and why to study users of your technology*
- The user study should be reflective - Rather than describing only what do you do; you need to describe *why and how* you are doing that
- You can be critical towards user involvement, but you need to justify your choices
- You need to show that you are familiar with theories, concepts and methods provided in this course
- You can make use of your previous assignments (not copy-past them though!)
- The lenght of the user study is10-15 pages + references



Structure of the user study

The user study consists of the following parts:

1) Introducing technology and the user group (1 page)

2) Presenting relevant theories, concepts and perspectives offered in the course (at least 2) on these users (2-4 pages). *Argue for your choices!*

3) Selecting and justify one or more relevant methods to examine these perspectives on the user (2-3 pages).

4) Collect data from the users (e.g. interviews or survey responses, 1-2 pages)

5) Conclude by explaining how the obtained knowledge will help them for the design of their proposed technology (1-2 pages).

- Remember to use course literature and appropriate reference style!
- You can choose which reference style to use, but be consistent!: https://www.kth.se/en/biblioteket/skriva-referera/skriv-referenser-1.856564

Introducing technology and user group (1-2 pages)

- **Description of your technology and design**

- Why is this technology innovative? How is this technology contributing to health and well-being?
- Who are the users? (try to avoid being too general, such as ”this is for all”)
- Include a description of potential users e.g., by creating *user personas or scenarios* (age, gender, socio-demographic background, lifestyle, needs and interests) – there can be many!
- How and in what environment the technology is used? Hospital, clinics, private home, public space?
- Is the technology used collaboratively (many users at the same time) or individually (only one user)?
- Try to identify a research gap and present concrete research questions for your study



Example: User persona



Assaf

About

- 28 Years old.
- 9K per month.
- Rent apartment in Tel Aviv
- Medium- High Tech proficiency.

Why he get to the market ?

- Price
- Local food
- Quality
- Vibes

2-3
Per month
Market visits

Core Needs

Find exactly where are the groceries he wants.
Remembers where to find each shops he liked.
Makes shopping faster with direct route.
Finds a vegetarian place to eat.
Find a new and recommended place to eat.

Motivation

Loves the market vibes and variety.
Usually finds something new to try.
Easy access to things he needs
Love the market location and like to hang around after he finishes shopping.

"I love doing my shopping at the market, but I wish to finish it quickly so I could get something to eat"

Pain Points

Have a hard time to find a resturant that serve vegetarian food .

Example: Design scenario

- Written or visualised description of how technology is used by potential users in a certain situation

- Examples from design scenarios: https://www.interaction-design.org/literature/topics/user-scenarios

- Design scenario is a ‘user story’ that describes how users interact with the technology

Presenting theories and concepts (2-4 pages)

- **Presentation of relevant theories, concepts and perspectives offered in this course (at least 2!)**

- Such as technology adoption models, domestication theory, uses and gratifications theory, technology scripts, social shaping of technology, configuring users etc.
- Defining what these concepts and theories mean…
- … But also **why and how they are important to your study**!
- You can be critical and reflective, but it is important to **argue and justify your choices**!
- You can add practical examples of situations where the technology is used



Selecting methods to examine users (2-3 pages)

- **Presentation of the concept and method of user involvement**
- Analysis of the barriers and benefits of user involvement in your technology
- Description how would you involve users (e.g., different levels of user involvement – what is appropriate to you?)
- **Choosing a methodology:**
  - Quantitative survey
  - Qualitative interviews or ethnography
  - Mixed method approach
- **Description of the method** (e.g. structure for questionnaire or semi-structure interview) and data collection (e.g., how and where the data is collected)

Collecting data from the users (1-2 pages)

- **Presentation of results from the user study**, including results from the interviews of survey questionnaire

- The sample should include, for instance, 2-3 interviews or 5-10 survey responses

- Presentation of the participants characteristics (e.g. age, gender, occupational role, etc)

- Presentation of results in structured format, by answering the reseach questions



Conclusion on how (1-2 pages)

- Description of how the obtained knowledge will help you in technology design and development
- What new aspects or approaches can these concepts provide for technology development
- Discussion on the barriers and benefits of using these theories and methods
- How will you apply this knowledge after the course



Assessment criteria

- The assessment of the reports is based on the following criteria with the scale A – F:

- Description of the idea and technology (20 %)
- Explanation of the user group (20 %)
- Application of theory and concepts (20 %)
- Selection of methods and data collection (20 %)
- Language, visual presentation, clarity, argumentation (20 %)

Final tips - How to move forward

- Argue and justify your choices!
- Connect theory and method to your technology
- Use practical examples (and visualisations, if possible)
- Show that you have the ability to critically reflect theory (not only by summarising it - rather answering questions ‘how’ and ‘why’)
- Good luck! Deadline for the final version is **May 31st**

